

and any worries that he had disappeared. Then Daniel moved into the losing phase. He started losing more often than he won. He would leverage his stock purchase by borrowing money to buy and sell stocks. Finally, he moved into the desperation phase. Playing the market became an obsession. His life centered on getting even and paying off debts. His wife no longer wanted to be with him since he was so unpleasant. In desperation, Penny even got rid of his computer so he couldn't make any more trades online. That didn't work. Daniel just started to make trades over the phone.

When time came to pay taxes, he found he needed to account for each separate transaction. Since he traded daily, this involved an enormous amount of paperwork. He had to hire an accountant to help him sort out the mess. He ended up paying his accountant all of the profits he had earned from his first year of day trading!

Penny was fed up with his destructive behavior and decided to leave him. Only when she left did Daniel finally wake up to the consequences of his behavior. Daniel had allowed himself to become mesmerized by his ability to trade stocks in real time on the Internet. With the constant access to the market that online trading affords, Daniel found it addictive. His day trading addiction became no different than that of an alcoholic in the stress it placed on his family.

Daniel took the first step to recovery by going to a Gamblers Anonymous meeting. He has been attending for several years now and has returned to his day job as a construction supervisor. Any investment decisions are now made through his company's retirement fund manager.

Not everyone will become addicted if they engage in online trading. But short of addiction, many can find themselves trading so often that they wish they could stop or at least slow down. Watching your stock portfolio every day is unnecessary

